



El Cajon CA PD Transparency Portal

Last updated: Wed Jul 15 2026

OVERVIEW

El Cajon PD (CA) uses Flock Safety technology to capture objective evidence without compromising on individual privacy. El Cajon PD utilizes retroactive searches to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, El Cajon PD utilizes real-time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals.

POLICIES

What's Detected

License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.
Data is owned by El Cajon PD and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), personal use.

Access Policy

All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.

USAGE

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

103

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to El Cajon CA PD data.

Acworth GA PD	Ada County ID SO
Adams County WA SO	Adrian MI PD
Alabaster AL PD	Alameda County CA SO
Albion MI DPS	Alexandria VA PD
Alhambra CA PD	Altoona IA PD
Amador County CA Sheriff' ...	Amarillo TX PD
Amberley Village OH PD	Anaheim CA PD

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Vehicles detected in the last 30 days

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

836,830

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

15,304

Number of Searches

Total user search sessions over the last 30 days.

633

ADDITIONAL INFO

Success Story

On the first day of implementation, Flock Safety automated license plate reader (ALPR) cameras immediately demonstrated their value to the El Cajon Police Department with two successful apprehensions.

On July 28, 2023, a real-time alert notified officers that a vehicle stolen during a violent robbery and carjacking in Lemon Grove on July 22 had been detected by the ALPR system. Through rapid coordination between agencies, a San Diego County Sheriff’s deputy located the vehicle within minutes and safely apprehended two suspects.

Later that evening, another ALPR alert identified a vehicle that had been stolen during a commercial burglary in Winterhaven, California (Imperial County) on July 26. An El Cajon Police officer quickly located the occupied vehicle in a gas station parking lot and arrested the suspect without incident.

These two incidents on day one highlight how real-time ALPR technology can quickly connect crimes across jurisdictions and help officers safely and efficiently locate stolen vehicles and suspects.

Success Story

On October 5, 2024, at approximately 9:15 PM, officers from the El Cajon Police Department responded to a reported stabbing in the 800 block of Benedict Avenue in El Cajon, California. Upon arrival, officers encountered a suspect armed with a knife. When officers attempted to detain him, the suspect fled on foot and attempted to carjack a passing motorist, who was able to escape. Officers continued searching the area and ultimately apprehended the suspect. He was taken into custody and booked into the San Diego County Sheriff's Office Central Jail.

The victim, a 71-year-old male, was found with a stab wound to his torso and transported to a nearby hospital. On October 12, the victim died from his injuries.

During the investigation, detectives determined that the victim and suspect both homeless had recently met, and the victim had been giving the suspect a ride when their vehicle broke down. During the suspect’s attempt to flee the scene, Flock Safety automated license plate reader cameras helped investigators identify the motorist the suspect attempted to carjack, providing critical witness information that supported the homicide investigation.

Success Story

Over the course of one month, a suspect committed at least eleven thefts at Food 4 Less, repeatedly entering the store, concealing groceries and health products, and leaving without paying. The total reported loss exceeded \$4,000.

A detective with the El Cajon Police Department developed a key lead when the suspect vehicle’s license plate was identified and linked to surveillance footage from the store. The investigation led to the identification of a 39-year-old resident of unincorporated El Cajon who was also found to be selling the stolen merchandise. The vehicle’s license plate was entered into the city’s Flock Safety automated license plate reader system. On May 9, the system generated an alert when the vehicle was detected traveling southbound on North Mollison Avenue. A patrol officer quickly located and stopped the vehicle, confirmed the suspect as the driver, and took him into custody. He was later booked into the San Diego County Sheriff's Office Central Jail on charges including organized retail theft, grand theft, and conspiracy.

Success Story

On February 29, 2024, at approximately 4:14 PM, the El Cajon Police Department responded to reports of gunfire at a dental office on North Magnolia Avenue in El Cajon, California. Officers arrived within minutes and located three victims suffering from gunshot wounds. Despite lifesaving efforts, one adult male died at the scene, while two additional victims were transported to the hospital in serious but stable condition.

Witnesses reported that the suspect, a 29-year-old local resident and former patient of the dental office, fled in a white U-Haul pickup truck. Officers quickly utilized the city’s Flock Safety automated license plate reader system, which captured an image of the vehicle and its license plate. Investigators rapidly identified the rental vehicle and confirmed it had been rented in San Diego.

Because this information was obtained so quickly, detectives were able to distribute the suspect vehicle’s photo and license plate to the public through news media and department social media, which resulted in his arrest within hours after his murderous rampage.

Success Story

On October 28, 2023, at approximately 11:57 PM, the El Cajon Police Department responded to multiple 9-1-1 calls reporting a large house party and gunshots in the 700 block of Mahogany Drive in El Cajon, California. Officers arrived to find numerous individuals fleeing the area and located two victims—a 16-year-old male and an 18-year-old male—suffering from critical gunshot wounds. Both victims later died after being transported to local trauma hospitals.

Homicide detectives determined that at least two suspects fled the scene in a vehicle prior to police arrival. Investigators used the city’s Flock Safety automated license plate reader cameras to identify the suspected getaway vehicle, which led to the identification of two suspects from San Diego.

One suspect was later taken into custody by the Chula Vista Police Department on November 18 during an unrelated firearm arrest. On November 20, officers and detectives from the El Cajon Police Department, with assistance from the United States Marshals Service Fugitive Task Force and the East County Regional Gang Task Force, located and arrested the second suspect in San Diego, bringing the homicide investigation closer to resolution.